

Oversea-Chinese Banking Corp. (OCBC.SI): First Take: 1Q25 inline as robust non-NII offsets weaker NIM; 2025 guidance intact

OCBC posted 1Q25 net profit of S\$1,883mn, -5% yoy/-15% qoq, inline with GSe (+3%). Driving the results were : **(1) Robust Non-NII** (+15% vs GSe) underpinned by **strong insurance income** on the back of stronger investment performance and improved claims experience, **other non-NII** on trading income as well as **strong fee income** on robust wealth management and loan related fees; **(2) Opex was well controlled** with CIR at 38.7% **(3) Provisions that were largely inline** at 26bps vs GSe of 24bps due to prudent provisioning. **Asset quality remained benign** with low new NPA formation and stable NPL ratio of 0.9%. That said putting pressure on the numbers was the **weaker NII** driven largely by **NIMs falling 11bps qoq** driven by falling loan yields and the deployment of liquidity into high quality assets. Loan growth was 1% qoq.

2025 guidance is unchanged with: (1) NIMs to be around 2% (GSe 1.95%); (2) Mid-single digit loan growth (GSe 2.6%); (3) CIR of low 40% (GSe 41.5%); (4) Credit cost of 20-25bps (GSe 24bps).

Overall results were decent though there is slight disappointment from its sharp decline in NIMs unlike peers. That said the reiteration of its 2025 guidance and the commitment to its previously announced S\$2.5bn capital returns is positive. We await more comments at the company's analyst briefing at 9.00am local time today.

Key highlights:

- **Net interest income was 5% below GSe**, -4% yoy/-4% qoq. Loan growth was inline with GSe, +1% qoq/+7% yoy, ahead of guidance of mid-single digit loan growth. 1Q growth was led by Singapore and rest of the world, while Indonesia and Malaysia were flattish and a small decline in Greater China.
- **NIM fell 11bps qoq to 2.04%, lower than GSe of 2.10%**, but inline with guidance of around 2%. The margin compression was due to a faster decline in loan yield vs deposit rate in the backdrop of rate cut and deployment of excess liquidity into high quality investment which is accretive to NII but dilutive to margin. LDR declined to 80.0% from 4Q's 81.7%.
- **Non-interest income came in above GSe**, at +10% yoy/+36% qoq, driven by robust insurance income (+6% yoy/ +203%qoq) due to strong investment performance and improved claim experience, and strong other non-NII (+9%

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yoy/ +34% qoq) due to market condition, as well as strong fee income (+14% yoy/ +6% qoq) supported by wealth and loan-related fees.

- **NPL ratio was flattish qoq at 0.9%**, with lower new NPA in corporate/commercial banking and lower NPA in consumer banking.
- **Credit cost came in at 26bps on GS calculation**, including 12bps of SP and 14bps of GP. CoC was higher than GSe of 24bps, higher than guidance of 20-25bps. NPL coverage ratio increased to 162% from 159% in 4Q24 and coverage for performing loans is stable at 0.9%.
- **Expenses were +5% yoy/ -9% qoq, 3% below GSe**, with cost to income ratio (CIR) for the quarter at 38.7%, higher than 1Q24's 37.1%.

Our 12-month target price (2-staged DDM based) for OCBC is S\$18.30. Key risks: (-) Sudden or sharper-than-expected FED cut cycle; (-) Unexpected dilutive M&A activity. Remain Buy.

Exhibit 1: OCBC 1Q25 Earnings Summary

Income statement (\$mn)	1Q24	2Q24	3Q24	4Q24	1Q25	YoY %	QoQ %	1Q25E	Actual vs. Est (%)
Net interest income	2,437	2,430	2,433	2,455	2,345	(4)	(4)	2,461	(5)
Fee & Commission	479	466	508	517	546	14	6	532	3
Insurance Income	289	294	233	101	306	6	203	235	30
Other Non-Interest Income	421	439	628	343	458	9	34	373	23
Non-Interest Income	1,189	1,199	1,369	961	1,310	10	36	1,140	15
Operating Income	3,626	3,629	3,802	3,416	3,655	1	7	3,601	2
Operating Expenses	(1,346)	(1,373)	(1,463)	(1,560)	(1,415)	5	(9)	(1,454)	(3)
Pre-Prov Op Profit (PPOP)	2,280	2,256	2,339	1,856	2,240	(2)	21	2,147	4
Loan Loss Provisions	(169)	(144)	(169)	(208)	(212)	25	2	(192)	10
Pre-tax Profit	2,343	2,332	2,415	1,887	2,297	(2)	22	2,202	4
Net Profit	1,982	1,944	1,974	1,687	1,883	(5)	12	1,834	3
Balance sheet (\$mn)									
Assets	597,177	598,890	602,006	625,050	636,655	7	2	632,962	1
Gross Loans	301,000	303,983	305,000	319,166	322,000	7	1	321,271	0
Customer Deposits	369,841	369,835	369,280	390,687	402,732	9	3	395,183	2
CAMEL Ratios (%)									
Core Tier 1	16.2	15.5	15.6	15.3	15.5			16.0	
NPL Ratio	0.98	0.93	0.90	0.89	0.90			0.90	
Provisions / Average Loans (bps)	23	19	22	27	26			24	
Reported Net Interest Margin	2.27	2.20	2.18	2.15	2.04			2.10	
Cost-to-Income Ratio	37.1	37.8	38.5	45.7	38.7			40.4	
Loan-to-Deposits	81.4	82.2	82.6	81.7	80.0			81.3	

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

OCBC.SI		12m Price Target: S\$18.30		Price: S\$16.16		Upside: 13.2%	
Buy		GS Forecast					
Market cap: S\$72.4bn / \$56.1bn 3m ADTV: S\$132.5mn / \$99.5mn Singapore Asean Financials M&A Rank: 3			12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E	
		Net inc. (S\$ mn)	7,587.0	7,079.3	7,212.6	7,618.3	
		EPS (S\$)	1.68	1.58	1.61	1.70	
		EPS growth (%)	8.1	(6.0)	1.9	5.6	
		P/E (X)	8.6	10.2	10.0	9.5	
		P/B (X)	1.1	1.2	1.2	1.1	
		ROA (%)	1.3	1.1	1.1	1.1	
		ROE (%)	13.7	12.1	11.9	11.9	
		Price/PPOP (X)	8.3	8.7	8.6	8.2	
		Dividend yield (%)	7.0	5.9	6.0	6.4	
		12/24	3/25E	6/25E	9/25E		
EPS (S\$)		0.37	0.41	0.41	0.39		

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 8 May 2025 close.

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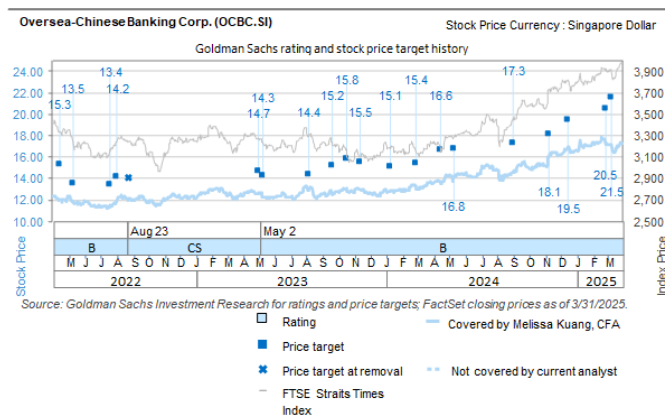
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